here'. Today, no one will dare to put up such a signage," Union home minister Amit Shah would often remind people during his election campaign speeches, alluding to a time when organised crime ruled the coastal town of Saurashtra. A similar situation used to prevail in Ahmedabad, where gang wars between bootleggers and extortion rings were a norm, hitting local businesses and leading to an overall sense of insecurity. Things have changed drastically, following a series of clearly stated measures and administrative will. Today, the strength of civil policemen per one lakh people stands at 122.8 in Gujarat. In relative terms, the number might be lower than states like Maharashtra (174.9), but Gujarat has registered just one case of rape and molestation per one lakh people—significantly lower than other big states. The case pendency of 30 per 1,000 cases is also on the lower side.

Best Performing and Most Improved Small State: Nagaland

For distant socio-political observers, the exceptional performance of Nagaland—a state often making news for the alleged misuse of the draconian Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA)—in the improvement of law and order may sound like an inexplicable paradox. But a hard look at the numbers showcases an encouraging trend for this northeastern hill state. According to the South Asia Terrorism Portal, between 2013 and 2017, 108 incidents of killing, including of civilians, terrorists and security forces, took place in Nagaland. In the next five years, between 2018 and 2022, the number came down sharply to just 17. In 2022, no casualty has been recorded till now. In other aspects of crime management too, the state has shown great progress among all small states. For instance, the number of murders has gone down from 32 in 2018 to 19 this year (till November). Nagaland Deputy Chief Minister Y. Patton, who holds the home portfolio, attributes this progress to the collective work of nearly 23,000 policemen and 87 police stations engaged in providing security to the nearly two million people in the state. "We were known to be a disturbed state. That tag is now a thing of the past. It's a peaceful state now. While our police force has worked relentlessly in the past five years, the support from the Union government led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has worked wonders," says Patton.

NAGALAND DEPUTY CM ATTRIBUTES THE TOP RANK TO THE STATE POLICE'S EFFORTS AND UNION GOVT'S SUPPORT

Most Improved Big State: Uttar Pradesh

CM Yogi Adityanath's 'bulldozer' action against criminals has become synonymous with the law and order apparatus

BEST PERFORMING BIG STATES LAW AND ORDER

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 140	RANK 2021
1	GUJARAT	90.5	1
2	PUNJAB	85.1	2
3	UTTAR PRADESH	83.2	4
4	TAMIL NADU	81.2	3
5	HIMACHAL PRADESH	79.6	6
6	KERALA	77.2	5
7	WEST BENGAL	73.8	8
8	BIHAR	71.7	10
9	KARNATAKA	71.1	7
10	ANDHRA PRADESH	67.0	12
11	UTTARAKHAND	66.0	9
12	MAHARASHTRA	62.7	11
13	JHARKHAND	59.8	16
14	CHHATTISGARH	50.1	17
15	TELANGANA	47.1	13
16	RAJASTHAN	46.1	14
17	MADHYA PRADESH	43.8	15
18	ODISHA	38.9	19
19	HARYANA	37.0	18
20	ASSAM	33.7	20

BEST PERFORMING SMALL STATES LAW AND ORDER

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 140	RANK 2021
1	NAGALAND	117.9	1
2	MANIPUR	103.0	2
3	PUDUCHERRY	101.9	8
4	SIKKIM	94.9	4
5	MIZORAM	94.0	3
6	GOA	88.3	6
7	TRIPURA	85.3	9
8	MEGHALAYA	82.7	5
9	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	76.9	7
10	DELHI	52.2	10

Parameters: Actual strength of civil policemen, total cases (under IPC), incidence of murder, kidnapping, rape, molestation and riots, pending cases/ population